Automated log analysis

After deployment, governance continues through monitoring and feedback. Decision logs from the PDPs are automatically collected and analyzed for anomalies, policy drift, and unexpected decision paths. These analyses identify redundant or conflicting rules, verify that policies are producing intended outcomes, and surface candidates for review or retirement. Findings from log analysis feed directly into the update phase of the policy lifecycle.

A/B testing for policy changes

For especially sensitive or high-impact policies, ACME uses A/B testing to compare outcomes before full rollout. A small portion of traffic is routed to a new policy version while the rest continues with the current one. The system then evaluates authorization decisions, response times, and error rates across both groups. This controlled testing helps ACME verify policy logic and performance under real conditions before making organization-wide changes.

Together, these tools turn governance principles into enforceable practice. They allow ACME to govern not only the content of policies but also the process by which policies are authored, reviewed, deployed, and evolved —maintaining a living, auditable expression of the company's institutional will.

14.3 Governance frameworks for policy management

Authorization policies are evolving expressions of institutional will. Governance frameworks ensure these expressions stay consistent, accountable, and aligned with the organization's values and operations over time. While the policy lifecycle describes how a policy evolves, governance defines who is responsible, what standards are applied, and how those standards are enforced.